

INDEPENDENT M&E REVIEW

Brief 3 of the NASSP/HUP Independent M&E Series

Nigeria's National Home-Grown School Feeding Programme (NHGSFP)

Feeding the Bet: An Independent M&E Review of Nigeria's Home-Grown School Feeding Programme, 2016–2025

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Feeding the Bet · Independent M&E Review of Nigeria's NHGSFP, 2016–2025

Data Sources

34 curated sources — official, legislative, academic, media, World Bank/UN, CSO, and international comparators

This brief is the third in the Independent M&E Reviews of Nigerian Social Investment Programmes, a working-paper series produced by the author as an independent contribution to the public evidence base on Nigeria's social-protection and human-capital portfolio. Brief 1 reviewed the NASSP Household Uplifting Programme; Brief 2 reviewed the AGILE adolescent-girls education investment. The series welcomes correction, contradiction, and triangulation by readers with access to primary data.

Note on Scope

This brief is a secondary analysis of 34 publicly available sources covering Nigeria's NHGSFP from 2016 to 2025. It does not conduct primary fieldwork. Where sources conflict — particularly on beneficiary counts and budget disbursements — the contradiction is named rather than resolved. Readers seeking primary data on programme delivery are directed to the CGIAR/IFPRI Osun State baseline study and the ANEEJ/NSIO Social Protection Baseline Report.

Executive Summary

01

The Bet

The NHGSFP committed the Nigerian federal government to a deceptively simple wager: that a daily mid-day meal costing ₦70 per child — later approved at ₦100, though never implemented at that rate — would increase primary school enrolment, improve child nutrition, stimulate smallholder agriculture, and create over one million ancillary jobs simultaneously. At its 2022 peak, the programme claimed 9,990,862 pupils across 53,000+ schools and 127,000 cooks. Those figures are real. No public verification framework exists to confirm these figures, and no per-state or per-quarter delivery record has ever been released for any programme year after 2020.

02

The Peak and the Break

Between 2017 and early 2023, the NHGSFP expanded from 14 states and 2.8 million pupils to claimed coverage of 33+ states and nearly 10 million pupils. On 12 January 2024, President Tinubu suspended the programme. The Guardian Nigeria reported that the suspension stranded 9 million+ pupils and 250,000 jobs. A Parliamentary probe followed in July 2024. As of mid-2026, Tribune Online (Akintola, 2025) confirms that programmes have not been fully resumed despite presidential approval granted on 21 January 2025 — a gap of more than seventeen months between approval and resumption.

03

The Budget Arithmetic That Does Not Reconcile

The House Committee on Public Accounts scrutinised ₦186 billion in claimed cumulative NHGSFP expenditure to 2020. The component figures disclosed — ₦63.2bn (2018), ₦32.2bn (2019), ₦124.4bn (2020) — sum to ₦219.8bn, leaving a ₦33.8bn discrepancy that no public document reconciles. Of the ₦186bn headline, the Committee was told only ₦64bn reached direct feeding. In real terms — indexed to NBS food inflation — the unchanged nominal ₦70 per child per meal retains less than one-sixth of its 2016 food-purchasing power by 2025: a silent erosion that no fraud register captures. A separate fraud timeline documents ₦68m diverted in Kogi State (2019), a ₦2.67bn allegation under investigation from the COVID period (2020), and ₦30bn+ recovered from NSIPA by December 2025. The three orders of magnitude separating documented fraud incidents from the December 2025 recovery is itself a finding.

04

The Measurement Blind Spot

There is no publicly accessible NHGSFP dashboard, no quarterly pupil-fed report for any year since 2020, and no state-disaggregated disbursement release that reconciles with budget appropriations. The World Bank/NASSCO (2025) reports that only 44 per cent of Nigeria's social protection benefits reach the poor, despite the NHGSFP being praised for individual-level targeting. A scoping review of eight qualifying studies (Malque Pub/Academic Research, 2025) finds 11–42 per cent relative enrolment gains. That range — thirty-one percentage points wide — is not a research finding. It is the signature of a monitoring vacuum.

05

The Five Recommendations

This brief concludes with five actionable recommendations: (1) NSIPA to publish a quarterly state-level beneficiary and disbursement dashboard within 30 days of quarter-end; (2) allocate at least 1 per cent of the NHGSFP budget to independent third-party verification; (3) digitise the cook registry with biometric anchoring before any re-expansion; (4) trigger an automatic unit-cost review whenever NBS food-CPI rises more than 25 per cent from the ₦70 baseline; and (5) require a state co-financing readiness score before any federal-to-state programme handover.

Methodological Caveat

This brief draws entirely on secondary sources — official press releases, legislative oversight reports, investigative journalism, World Bank and UN assessments, academic cross-sectional studies, and civic data platforms. It cannot distinguish self-reported beneficiary counts from verified delivery records; where that distinction matters, it is flagged explicitly. The brief treats evidential gaps not as lacunae to be papered over but as the primary M&E finding: a programme that spent more than ₦186 billion of public money over its first five years produced no public verification record capable of establishing what that money delivered.

1. Programme History and Theory-of-Change Reconstruction

1.1 Origins and Design

Nigeria's National Home-Grown School Feeding Programme was first established in 2005 under the Obasanjo administration, piloted across 12 states before being suspended in 2007 due to what the official Renewed Hope portal (NSIPA, 2024) describes as 'inadequate planning, poor strategies and lack of resources.' The current iteration was formally launched by Vice President Yemi Osinbajo in June 2016, following a National Advocacy Meeting in May 2014 convened with support from the Partnership for Child Development (Imperial College London), the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation, the World Bank, and the Vitol Foundation. The strategic framework was codified in the Nigeria Home Grown School Feeding Strategic Plan 2016–2020.

The programme was initially channelled through the National Social Investment Office (NSIO) and subsequently restructured under the National Social Investment Programmes Agency (NSIPA). Its administrative home has migrated between ministries over its lifetime — from the Federal Ministry of Humanitarian Affairs and Disaster Management and Social Development to the Federal Ministry of Education under the Renewed Hope Agenda — reflecting persistent institutional ambiguity about whether NHGSFP is primarily a social-protection instrument or an education-sector intervention. That ambiguity has consequences for accountability: no single ministry owns the full monitoring function.

The unit cost was set at ₦70 per child per meal at launch in 2016. Okah (2022) documents the cost breakdown: ₦14 for an egg (Egg Wednesday), ₦10 for cook stipends, ₦5–6 for micronutrient fortification, ₦1 for quality assurance — leaving approximately ₦40 for the core food items. President Buhari approved an increase to ₦100 per child per meal in 2022; that rate was never implemented before the January 2024 suspension. As of 2025, NSIPA's stated target range is ₦500–₦1,000 per child (Adebowale/GazetteNG, 2025), a figure that, if applied to a 20-million-pupil target, implies daily outlays of ₦10–20 billion — a scale without precedent in Nigeria's social protection history.

1.2 The Five-Pillar Theory of Change

The NHGSFP is articulated across official sources (FMHADMSD, 2023; NSIPA, 2024; Okah, 2022) as a simultaneous intervention across five dimensions:

- Nutrition: one nutritious mid-day meal per school day for pupils in Primary 1–3 of public schools, addressing stunting affecting 37 per cent of school-aged children and underweight affecting 29 per cent at programme launch.
- Education: increased enrolment, attendance, and retention through the attendance incentive that a daily meal provides, with a net enrolment rate of 75.68 per cent in 2023 and a 30 per cent dropout rate to be addressed.
- Agriculture: sourcing of food items from local smallholder farmers and aggregators, stimulating rural agricultural production, targeting 80,000 farmers integrated into the supply chain.
- Employment: engagement of community cooks (predominantly women), creating formal stipend income for 100,000+ households.
- Social protection: targeting of the poorest enrolled households as meal beneficiaries, functioning as an in-kind transfer within Nigeria's Social Investment Programme.

The multi-pillar design is theoretically coherent. The UN OSAA policy paper (Duarte, 2024) synthesises the international evidence and estimates returns of up to \$9 for every \$1 invested in well-designed HGSF programmes.

The critical M&E question is not whether the five pillars are theoretically coherent — they are — but which causal arrows have measurement coverage and which do not. Grading each transition:

- Inputs → Activities: Weak. Budget allocation is partially traceable through BudgIT; cook recruitment numbers are administratively claimed. But whether funds released translated into food procured and meals prepared is unverified. No procurement audit has been published for any programme year.
- Activities → Outputs: Not verified. The programme's core output — meals served to specific children on specific days — exists only as a federal aggregate claim. No per-school, per-state, or per-quarter output record is publicly accessible for any period after 2020.
- Outputs → Outcomes: Partial, small-sample only. Enrolment gains of 11–42 per cent (Malque Pub/Academic Research, 2025) come from eight studies, none nationally representative. Nutritional outcomes are inconsistent across the two available studies (Agu et al., 2023). Smallholder income effects exist in one baseline comparison (CGIAR/IFPRI, 2024) with no endline.
- Outcomes → Impact: Absent. No national stunting trend, learning-outcome dataset, or rural poverty measure has been linked to NHGSFP participation in any published document. The causal chain stops here.

The unmeasured arrows are the M&E gaps Without measurement coverage of the lower causal arrows — Inputs to Activities, Activities to Outputs — claims at the Outcomes and Impact levels rest on the lower arrows being taken on faith. That faith is what an M&E framework is supposed to eliminate.

Table 1.1. NHGSFP Theory-of-Change: Measurement Coverage by Level.

Level	Description	Measurement Coverage	Status
INPUTS	₦ federal allocation; cooks recruited & trained; food procurement from smallholders; WASH & deworming supplies	Budget allocation partially known (BudgIT); cook numbers claimed but not independently verified; procurement data not published	△ Partial
ACTIVITIES	Daily meal preparation & delivery; school-based deworming; nutrition education; community sensitisation	Meal delivery assumed but not independently monitored; deworming confirmed in 2017 (19 states) but not sustained per Agu et al. (2023)	△ Partial
OUTPUTS	Meals served; cooks paid; farmers supplied; deworming tablets administered	Total pupils claimed (9.99M in 2022) but no verifiable per-school or per-state output data; cook payment delays documented (ICPC, 2019)	✗ Not verified
OUTCOMES	Increased enrolment & attendance; improved nutritional status; increased smallholder income; women's empowerment	Enrolment impact: 11–42% gain range from systematic review (Malque Pub, 2025); nutrition inconsistent (Agu et al., 2023); farmer income: 40% food security vs 20% non-beneficiary (CGIAR/IFPRI, 2024)	△ Partial
IMPACT	Reduced child stunting & malnutrition; improved learning outcomes; rural poverty reduction; human-capital formation	No national-level impact data published; only small-scale academic studies; suspension in 2024 erased cumulative gains	✗ No data

Key finding: The unmeasured arrows — particularly the Outputs→Outcomes and Outcomes→Impact transitions — constitute the core M&E gaps. There is no publicly available results framework, indicator matrix, or logframe for the NHGSFP.

2. Budget, Reach, and the Reconciliation Problem

2.1 Federal Allocation vs. Verified Disbursement

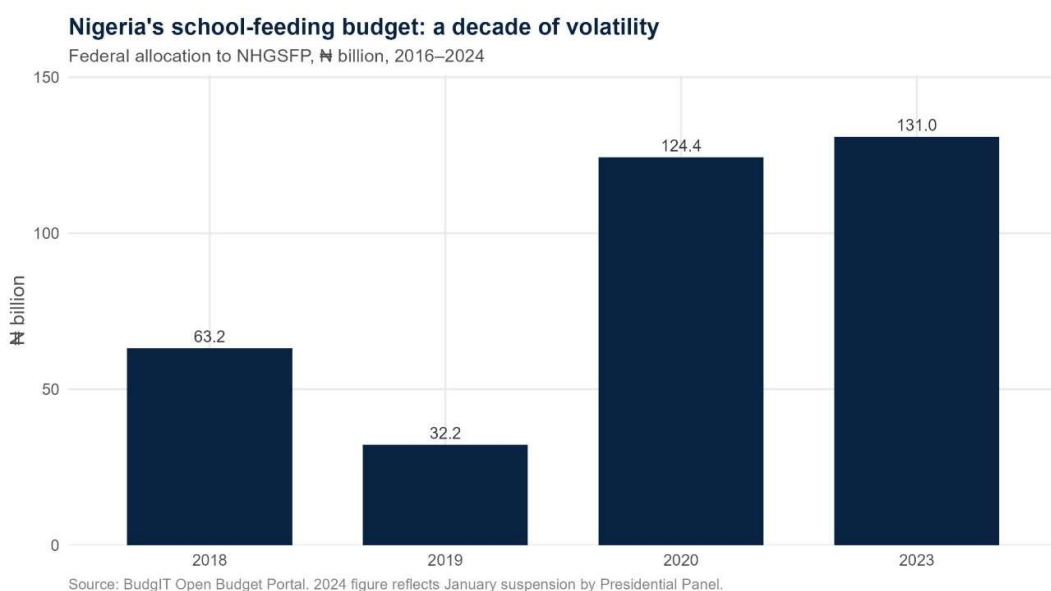
Nigeria's federal budget allocations to the NHGSFP are partially traceable through the BudgIT Open Budget Portal and legislative oversight records. What is not publicly available, for any year from 2020 onwards, is a reconciled statement of funds appropriated, funds released from the Treasury Single Account (TSA), funds transferred to state programme accounts, and funds verified as having reached cooks and food suppliers. The absence of this four-column reconciliation is not an accounting oversight. It is the core governance gap of the NHGSFP.

Table 2.1 below reconstructs the best available picture of annual budget allocations and verified disbursements from the sources in this review. Cells marked 'Not published' reflect genuine data voids, not researcher failures.

Table 2.1. NHGSFP — Federal Allocation and Verified Disbursement, 2016–2025.

Year	Programme Status	Claimed / Budgeted	Verified / Released	Gap / Note
2016	Launch year; limited to initial states	~₦15–20bn est.	Not published	—
2017	Expanded to 14 states, 2.8M pupils	₦6.2bn (Aug 2017 tranche only)	₦6.2bn (Guardian Nigeria, 2017)	Partial
2018	30 states, 9.5M pupils claimed	₦63.2bn (House Committee)	Not verified	Unreconciled
2019	Peak era; 33 states claimed	₦32.2bn (House Committee)	Not verified	Unreconciled
2020	COVID-19 pivot; household rations	₦124.4bn (House Committee)	~₦64bn to feeding (Baiyewu, 2020)	₦60.4bn overhead
2021	Post-COVID resumption	Not publicly released	—	—
2022	₦100 rate approved, never implemented	~₦131bn (WFP-reported)	Not disaggregated	—
2023	Programme operating at ~10M claim	\$174.81M (WFP School Meals Coalition)	—	Contradicts World Bank 2025 ceased-benefits finding
2024	Suspended January 12	₦100bn allocated (Nairametrics, 2025)	₦30bn+ recovered from NSIPA (Akintola, 2025)	Programme not resumed
2025	Pilot relaunch; 12 states	₦100bn in 2025 budget (Nairametrics, 2025)	Not disbursed at scale	Pilot-only

Sources: BudgIT Foundation (2026); Baiyewu (2020); Okah (2022); Nairametrics (2025); WFP School Meals Coalition; Akintola (2025). 'Unreconciled' denotes figures confirmed by the House Committee on Public Accounts as internally inconsistent.



The Arithmetic Gap

The ₦33.8 Billion That Requires Explanation

The House Committee on Public Accounts (Baiyewu, 2020) was presented with cumulative NHGSFP expenditure of ₦186 billion up to 2020. The component figures disclosed — ₦63.2bn (2018), ₦32.2bn (2019), ₦124.4bn (2020) — sum to ₦219.8bn, a surplus of ₦33.8bn over the stated cumulative. Three possible explanations exist, none of which has been officially confirmed:

First, the ₦186bn figure may exclude 2016–2017 spending, meaning the component figures span a different period than the cumulative total — a presentation failure rather than a financial one, but one that makes independent verification impossible. Second, the ₦33.8bn gap may represent disbursements that were classified under a different budget head — the Social Investment Programme umbrella — and therefore not attributed to NHGSFP in the cumulative figure even though they funded NHGSFP activities. Third, it may represent funds that were disbursed under NHGSFP budget lines but whose utilisation records were not presented to the Committee.

The Committee demanded a complete audit. No public audit report has been released in the six years since that demand. In the absence of one, all three explanations remain open — and the ₦33.8bn remains unaccounted for in any public document. Of the ₦186bn claimed, the Committee was further told that only ₦64bn reached direct feeding, meaning 66 per cent of claimed expenditure went to overheads, administration, and unspecified uses. The Committee described this as "outrageous and unacceptable."

2.2 Claimed Reach: The Numbers and Their Provenance

The NHGSFP has generated a succession of large beneficiary numbers, each sourced from federal administrative claims rather than independent verification. The central contradiction is stark: the WFP School Meals Coalition database records 10 million pupils receiving meals in 2023. Tribune Online (Akintola, 2025) reports that programmes were still not resumed as of late 2025, more than seventeen months after presidential approval of resumption on 21 January 2025. Two reputable bodies — one international, one domestic — are irreconcilable on the same programmatic period.

This is not a data problem soluble by averaging. It is evidence that the NHGSFP has no public information architecture capable of answering the question: 'How many children are being fed today?'

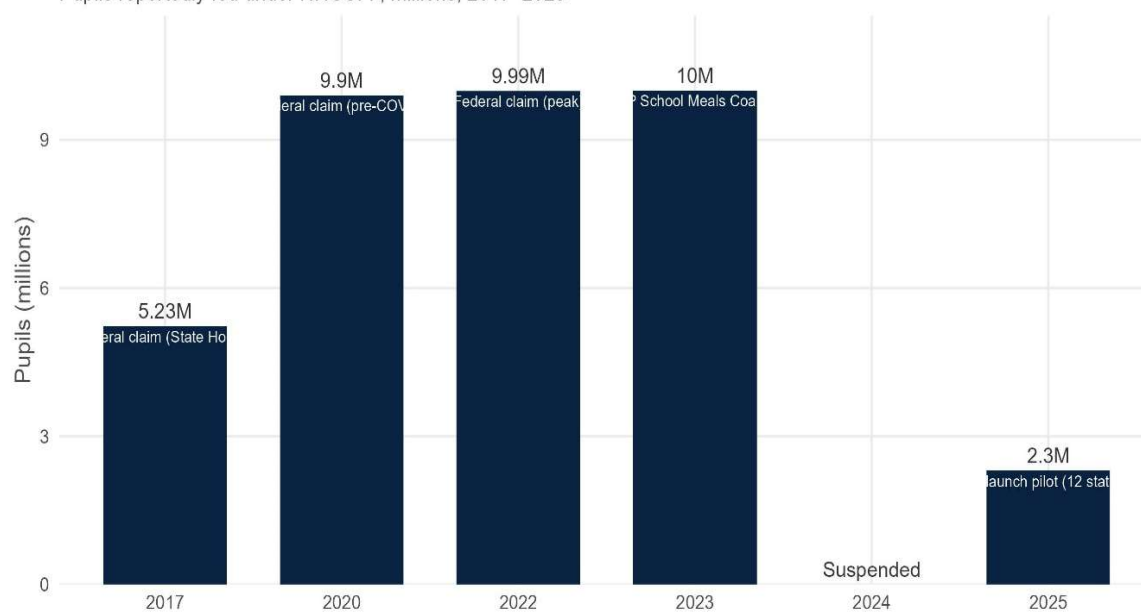
Table 2.2. NHGSFP — Pupil Reach Claims, 2017–2025.

Year	Pupils Claimed	Schools	Source	Verdict
Dec 2017	5,226,039	28,249	State House press release	Federal claim — no independent verification
2019	9,000,000+	n/a	Guardian Nigeria citing stranded-pupil figure	Peak-era claim
2020 (pre-COVID)	9,900,000	54,952	Majeed (2021) / BusinessDay	Federal claim
2022 (peak)	9,990,862	53,000+	Okah (2022) / Vanguard	Federal peak claim
2023	10,000,000	n/a	WFP School Meals Coalition database	International database — contradicts World Bank/NASSCO (2025) ceased-benefits finding
Jan 2024 (suspension)	0 (stranded: 9M+)	—	Guardian Nigeria (2025)	Confirmed suspension
2025 (pilot)	2,300,000	12 states / 21 NEDI	Agbajileke (2025) / Guardian Nigeria	Pilot phase; not national resumption

'Federal claim' denotes figures published by NSIO/NSIPA without third-party verification. WFP School Meals Coalition data is independently compiled but relies on government submissions.

From peak to suspension to pilot relaunch

Pupils reportedly fed under NHGSFP, millions, 2017–2025



Sources: State House (S27), BusinessDay (S29), Vanguard (S7), WFP SMC (S5b), Guardian (S5, S28), Renewed Hope NHGSFP portal (S26).

3. Cost-Effectiveness: The ₦70 Question

3.1 What ₦70 per Child per Meal Actually Buys

The ₦70 per-child-per-meal rate was set at the 2016 programme launch. Onah & Onah (2021) documented it was already inadequate by 2021 and recommended an increase to ₦150. Okah (2022) reported that ₦100 was approved in 2022 — but never implemented. The inflation arithmetic is stark: Nigeria's food Consumer Price Index rose by approximately 150 per cent between 2016 and 2024 (NBS data), meaning the real purchasing power of ₦100 in 2024 is equivalent to roughly ₦40 in 2016 terms — less than what the original ₦70 rate was designed to buy. Stated plainly: the programme in 2024 was purchasing, in real terms, approximately 57 per cent less food per child than it was at launch, while reporting the same nominal coverage figures. The WFP regional benchmark for school feeding unit costs is \$0.30–\$0.50 per child per day. At ₦100 per child and a parallel market rate of approximately ₦1,500 per dollar, Nigeria's 2024 allocation equates to roughly \$0.07 — between 14 and 23 per cent of the minimum regional benchmark. This is not a gap that rounding or administrative efficiency can close.

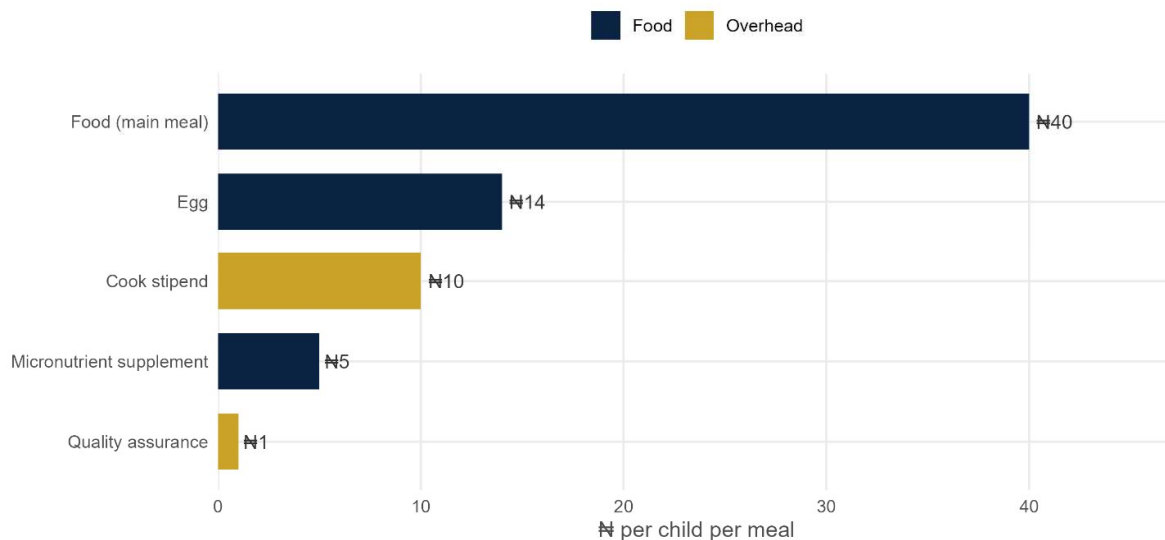
Table 3.1. NHGSFP Per-Meal Cost Breakdown: Where Every ₦70 Goes.

Component	₦ per Meal	Category	M&E Note
Food items (core)	~₦40	Food	Less than 60% of the ₦70 reaches actual food at 2016 prices
Egg (Egg Wednesday initiative)	₦14	Food	Weekly egg adds nutritional value but reduces daily food budget
Cook stipends	₦10	Overhead	Often in arrears; stipend delays documented across multiple states (Onah & Onah, 2021; Majeed, 2021)
Micronutrient fortification	₦5–6	Food	Integration with deworming campaign (Albendazole, Ivermectin, Praziquantel) inconsistently maintained after 2017
Quality assurance	₦1	Overhead	No public QA report released for any programme year
TOTAL (nominal, 2016–2023)	₦70	—	₦100 approved 2022, never implemented; ₦500–₦1,000 target range announced 2025 (Adebowale, 2025)

Source: Okah (2022) / Vanguard, citing Federal Ministry of Humanitarian Affairs breakdown. Onah & Onah (2021) recommend revising the rate to ₦150/meal.

Of every ₦70, only ₦59 buys food

Per-meal cost breakdown under NHGSFP (nominal, 2016–2023)



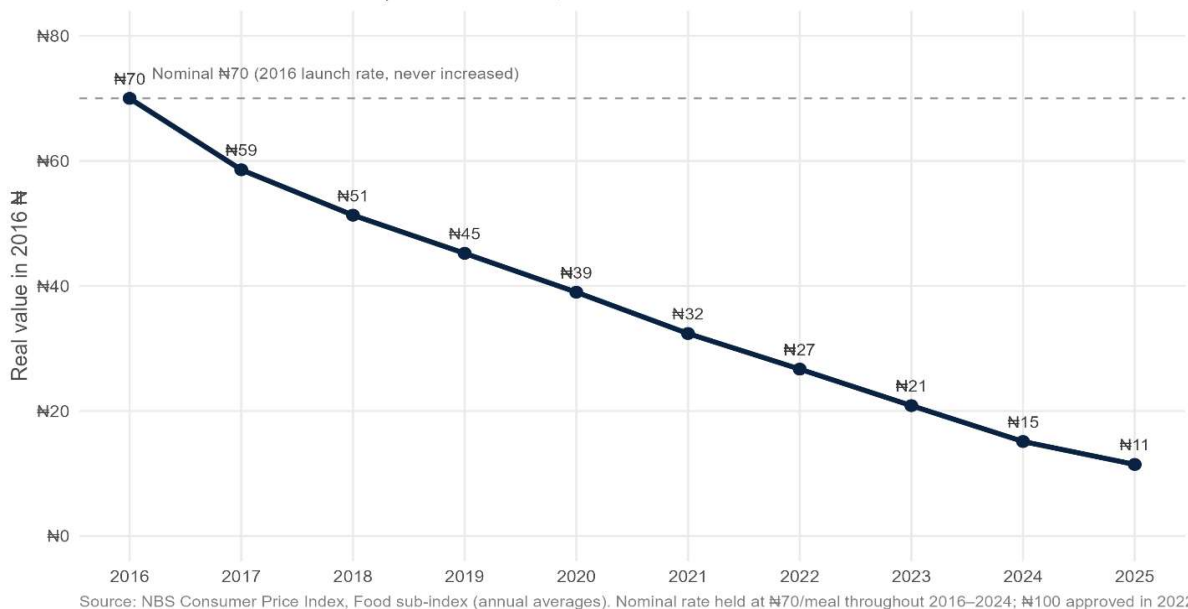
Source: Vanguard (S7), per Federal Ministry of Humanitarian Affairs breakdown. Onah & Onah (2021, S4) recommend revising rate to

By 2025, the nominal ₦70 retains the food-purchasing power of approximately ₦11 in 2016 terms — less than one-sixth of its launch value. NSIPA's stated 2025 target range of ₦500–₦1,000 per child (Adebowale/GazetteNG, 2025) implicitly acknowledges this collapse, but no formal indexation mechanism has been published, no automatic-review trigger has been gazetted, and no parliamentary instrument compels the unit cost to track food inflation. A programme whose unit cost is set once and never indexed to inflation is, in real terms, a different programme every year.

The NHGSFP unit cost was set at ₦70 per child per meal at launch in 2016 and held there through the programme's January 2024 suspension. The ₦100 rate approved by President Buhari in 2022 was never implemented in disbursement (Okah, 2022). Beyond the question of whether the nominal allocation was sufficient, a quieter failure compounds it: the silent erosion of what that allocation actually buys. Deflating the nominal ₦70 by the NBS Food CPI exposes the scale of that erosion across the programme's lifetime.

₦70 in 2016 buys what ₦11 buys in 2025

Real-terms value of the NHGSFP per-meal allocation, NBS Food CPI deflator



Source: NBS Consumer Price Index, Food sub-index (annual averages). Nominal rate held at ₦70/meal throughout 2016–2024; ₦100 approved in 2022

By 2025, the nominal ₦70 retains the food-purchasing power of approximately ₦11 in 2016 terms — less than one-sixth of its launch value. NSIPA's stated 2025 target range of ₦500–₦1,000 per child (Adebowale/GazetteNG, 2025) implicitly acknowledges this collapse, but no formal indexation mechanism has been published, no automatic-review trigger has been gazetted, and no parliamentary instrument compels the unit cost to track food inflation. A programme whose unit cost is set once and never indexed to inflation is, in real terms, a different programme every year.

3.2 The Inflation Erosion Problem

A programme that feeds 10 million children with a fixed per-child cost denominated in nominal naira faces a structural problem in a high-inflation economy: the real value of the feeding allocation falls every year without a budget decision to raise it, creating invisible rationing — fewer, smaller, or lower-quality meals — that the administrative reach statistics do not detect.

The Onah & Onah (2021) recommendation of ₦150 per meal was itself already in arrears of inflation by the time of the 2024 suspension. The NSIPA-stated target range of ₦500–₦1,000 per child (Adebowale, 2025) represents a 7-to-14-fold increase from the original ₦70 rate. Applied to 10 million pupils over 20 feeding days per month, a ₦500 rate implies a daily outlay of ₦5 billion and an annual programme cost of approximately ₦1.2 trillion — more than three times Nigeria's entire current spending on social protection as a share of GDP (World Bank/NASSCO, 2025: 0.14% of GDP).

The Cost-Ambition Arithmetic

Target (Adebowale, 2025): 50 million pupils by 2026. Rate: ₦500–₦1,000 per child per meal. Feeding days: 20 per month $\times$ 10 months = 200 per year. At ₦500: $50M \times 500 \times 200 =$ ₦5 trillion annually. At ₦1,000: ₦10 trillion annually. Nigeria's 2025 federal budget totals approximately ₦54 trillion. The feeding programme alone, at the government's own stated parameters, would require 9–19 per cent of the entire national budget. This arithmetic is not a critique of ambition. It is a measurement gap: no published budget document reconciles the 50-million-pupil target with a funding envelope or phasing plan.

3.3 What the Unit Cost Does Not Capture

Three categories of cost are systematically excluded from the ₦70–₦100 per-child-per-meal framework, yet represent real programmatic expenditure:

- Cook stipend arrears: Multiple sources (Onah & Onah, 2021; Okah, 2022; Majeed, 2021) document that cook stipends are paid irregularly, with arrears running for months. When arrears accumulate, cooks absorb the cost by reducing meal quality or continuity. The unit-cost rate assumes timely payment; the delivery reality does not.
- Logistics and cold-chain: In states with hot-meal models, transport of cooked food from production points to schools creates costs that are not itemised in the ₦70 breakdown. Aggregator margins for sourcing from local farmers constitute an additional overhead layer not visible in the per-meal rate.
- M&E budget: No NHGSFP budget document reviewed for this brief includes a dedicated monitoring and evaluation line item. The absence of an M&E budget is not a neutral technical choice — it is the fiscal reason that no public verification framework exists. In Rwanda's WFP-supported HGSF programme (WFP Rwanda/USDA, 2026), M&E was integrated at the design stage with a USD 25 million total budget covering 140 schools over five years. Nigeria's programme covers 50,000+ schools with no published M&E allocation.

4. Delivery Bottlenecks, Fraud, and the Accountability Gap

4.1 Three Recurring Delivery Failures

Across eight years of programme operation, three delivery failure modes recur consistently in the available sources. Their persistence across administrations and states indicates structural causes rather than isolated incidents.

Phantom Beneficiary Lists

The Kogi State case (ICPC, 2019) is the clearest documented example: 627 and then 850 cooks' bank accounts were placed on lien without their knowledge, and funds transferred to 10 company accounts as payment for food supplies that were never delivered. The programme's beneficiary list contained real names attached to real accounts — but the transactions confirmed on paper bore no relationship to meals served in classrooms.

The COVID-19 case (Adedigba, 2020) extends the problem to the programme pivot itself: ₦2.67 billion was disbursed under the NHGSFP during the COVID-19 lockdown, when schools were physically closed. Whether these payments represented advance disbursements for pre-lockdown vendor debts, a separate Unity Colleges allocation, or simple fraud was never publicly resolved. Separately, Nasarawa State uncovered 349 'ghost schools' falsely listed as beneficiaries (Nairametrics, 2025).

Cook Stipend Arrears

Multiple sources (Onah & Onah, 2021; Okah, 2022; Majeed, 2021) document cook stipend arrears as a chronic feature of the programme across states and years. Cook stipends are paid through state government payment channels; federal fund disbursements to states do not guarantee onward transmission to cooks within the promised payment cycle. When arrears accumulate, cooks — predominantly women engaged as informal workers with no employment contract — absorb the cost through unpaid labour, reduced meal quality, or programme exit. The programme's claimed cook workforce of 107,862 (Majeed, 2021) and 126,000 (WFP School Meals Coalition) includes no attrition tracking, no stipend-payment verification record, and no grievance mechanism for non-payment.

State Capacity and Co-Financing Gaps

NHGSFP's official design assigns federal government responsibility for Primary 1–3 and state government responsibility for Primary 4–6 (Majeed, 2021). In practice, most states have not funded their co-financing obligation, and no state co-financing readiness assessment has been published. Guardian Nigeria reporting on the relaunch identifies 21 states onboarded to the NEDI digital platform — but 'onboarded' means data migration, not funding confirmed. The 2023 Kebbi suspension for ₦8.8 billion in unauthorised procurement contracts illustrates the state-level implementation fragility that underlies national reach figures.

4.2 The Fraud Timeline

Table 4.1. NHGSFP — Documented Fraud and Accountability Incidents, 2019–2025.

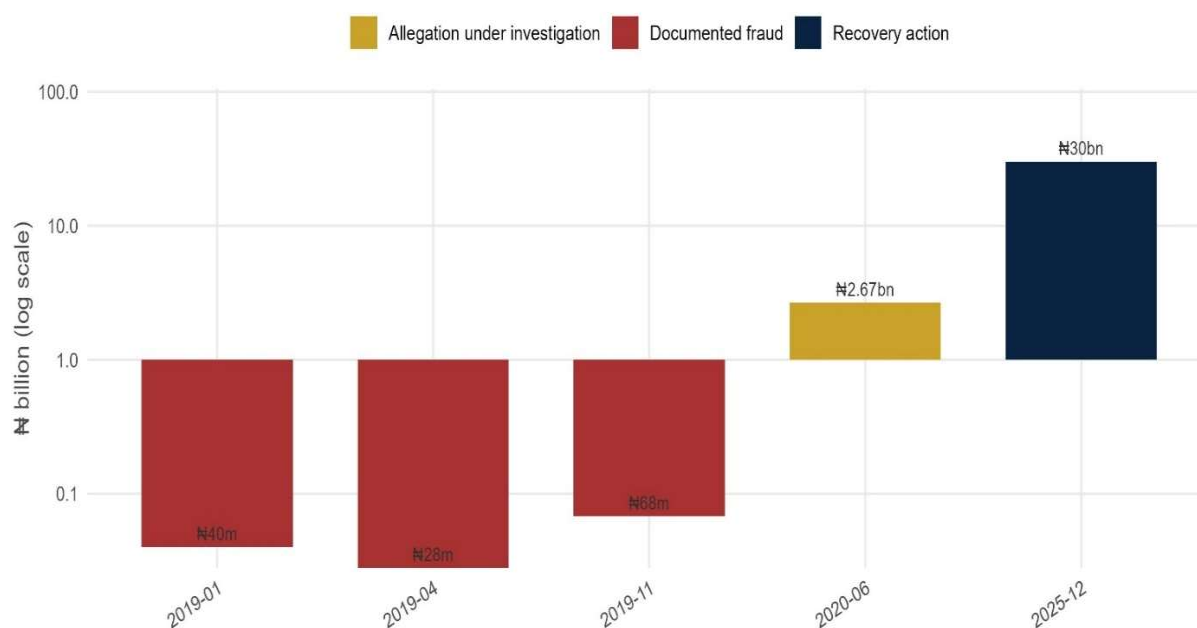
Date	Amount	Nature of Incident	Source	Status / Action
Jan 2019	₦40,388,558	Kogi State — 627 cooks' accounts placed on lien without consent; funds transferred to 10 company accounts	ICPC (2019)	ICPC arrest; Documented fraud
Apr 2019	₦27,708,495	Kogi State — 850 cooks' accounts; Focal Person and Programme Manager collusion with bank	ICPC (2019)	ICPC arrest; Documented fraud
Nov 2019	₦68,097,053 total	Kogi State combined — food supplies paid for but never delivered	ICPC (2019)	Two arrested

Oct 2020	₦2,670,000,000	a documented ₦2.67bn allegation under investigation arising from the COVID-19 school-closure period	Adedigba (2020) / Premium Times	Minister ordered investigation; ICPC confirmed inquiry
June 2020	₦186bn disputed	House Committee: cumulative expenditure; only ₦64bn to direct feeding; figures internally inconsistent	Baiyewu (2020) / Punch	Full audit demanded; audit not published
Dec 2025	₦30,000,000,000+	NSIPA funds seized from banks and payment providers; not remitted to TSA; programmes not resumed despite Jan 2025 presidential approval	Akintola (2025) / Tribune Online	House Ad-hoc Committee probe; recovery confirmed

'Documented fraud' denotes cases with an ICPC or ministerial confirmation. 'Disputed' denotes figures contested across sources.

Three orders of magnitude separate documented fraud from recovered funds

HGSF-linked fraud and recovery events, 2019–2025 (₦ billion, log scale)



Sources: ICPC (S8), Premium Times (S9), Tribune (S33). January 2024 federal suspension noted in text, not on chart.

Three Orders of Magnitude

The **₦68 million** Kogi fraud (ICPC, 2019) and the **₦30 billion** NSIPA seizure (Akintola, 2025) are separated by three orders of magnitude. This is not evidence that the programme got worse over time. It is evidence that small, undetected diversions compound: a **₦68 million** incident that produces two arrests but no systemic audit creates the conditions for a **₦30 billion** accumulation six years later. The NHGSFP had no public third-party verification mechanism, no publicly available quarterly disbursement report, and no independent monitoring allocation in any year between those two events.

5. The January 2024 Suspension and the Reporting Gap

5.1 The Suspension Timeline

The January 2024 suspension is the most consequential single event in the NHGSFP's eight-year history — not because programme suspensions are inherently catastrophic, but because of what the suspension revealed: a programme whose reach statistics had been reported continuously without a mechanism for verifying what those statistics represented. When the programme stopped, there was no baseline against which to measure the harm. There was no cook registry verifiable enough to count how many livelihoods were disrupted.

Table 5.1. NHGSFP Suspension and Relaunch — Chronology, January 2024 to December 2025.

Date	Event	M&E / Accountability Note
Jan 2023	NHGSFP silently stops implementing; caterers not paid since late 2022	Programme silence before formal suspension (Dorlach et al., 2025)
12 Jan 2024	President Tinubu suspends NHGSFP for an initial six-week review period via Special Presidential Panel	9M+ pupils stranded; 250,000 jobs disrupted (Guardian Nigeria, 2025)
Feb–Jun 2024	Suspension extends beyond six weeks; no public update on Panel findings	Programme silence; no official disbursement data released
11 Jul 2024	House of Representatives mandates Committees on Special Duties and Finance to investigate; describes outright suspension as 'counterproductive'	House Committee probe opens (Yakubu, 2024; Bakare, 2024)
Nov 2024	Nigeria commits at G20/Global Alliance Against Hunger and Poverty summit to relaunch by November 2024 and feed 20 million children annually	Commitment made; deadline missed (Global Alliance Against Hunger and Poverty, 2024)
21 Jan 2025	President grants approval for NSIPA to resume programmes	Approval issued — programmes not resumed (Akintola, 2025)
Sep 2025	Ministry of Education reports 2.3 million learners benefiting; announces pilot NHGSFP relaunch with direct payments to mothers	Pilot phase; 12 states; not national resumption (Agbajileke, 2025)
Dec 2025	House Ad-hoc Committee probes ₦30bn+ seized from NSIPA; funds recovered from banks and payment providers but not remitted to TSA	Recovery confirmed; release stalled (Akintola, 2025)

5.2 The Reporting Gap: A Governance Choice

The single most important M&E finding of this brief is not a number. It is an absence. There is no publicly accessible NHGSFP dashboard. There is no quarterly state-level report of pupils fed for any period from 2020 onwards. There is no published reconciliation of funds released against meals served for any programme year. Citizens, investigative journalists, researchers, and parliamentary committees cannot answer the basic question that every food-security programme should be able to answer in real time: 'How many children received a meal today, in which schools, funded by which disbursement?'

This is not a data-collection problem. NSIPA has a Management Information System. The programme operates through a mobile-verification application that state compliance reporting uses. The NEDI digital platform has onboarded 21 states (Agbajileke, 2025). The data infrastructure exists. The governance decision to make it public has not been made.

The World Bank/NASSCO (2025) quantifies the consequence: Nigeria spends 0.14 per cent of GDP on social protection against a global average of 1.5 per cent and a Sub-Saharan Africa average of 1.1 per cent. That investment produces a poverty-reduction impact of 0.4 percentage points — described by the World Bank as having 'almost no impact' on poverty. The BudgIT Foundation (2026) has demonstrated that real-time disbursement tracking is technically feasible in Nigeria's public finance environment. The same architecture, applied to NHGSFP pupil counts and disbursements, would cost less to implement than one week of programme running costs at peak scale.

6. International Comparators and What Nigeria's Programme Is Missing

Nigeria's NHGSFP does not operate in isolation. The 2024 UN OSAA policy paper (Duarte, 2024) positions Home-Grown School Feeding as a macroeconomic tool with documented returns of up to \$9 per \$1 invested across well-designed programmes in Sub-Saharan Africa. The CERFAM/WFP report (2026) documents 31 African countries participating in school feeding policy consultation; Ghana's digitised monitoring system delivered a 33 per cent increase in agricultural sales through HGSF procurement. Rwanda's five-year WFP/USDA-supported evaluation (WFP Rwanda/USDA, 2026) demonstrates that most programme targets are achievable when M&E is embedded from design, community engagement is sustained, and whole-of-government coordination is maintained.

Nigeria's programme is the largest in Africa by claimed scale. By the measures of verification, unit-cost sustainability, and public accountability architecture, it lags the field.

Table 6.1. NHGSFP in Comparative Perspective: Nigeria, Rwanda, Ghana, and International Benchmarks.

Country / Programme	Scale	Unit Cost	M&E Architecture	Accountability Note
Nigeria (NHGSFP)	9.9M (claimed peak); 2.3M (2025 pilot)	₦70 (~\$0.05 at 2024 rates)	No public dashboard; no independent verification	₦186bn claimed 2016–2020; 66% unaccounted overhead
Rwanda (WFP/USDA)	140 schools, 7 districts (2020–2025 evaluation)	USD 25M over 5 years (~\$35/pupil/year)	Rigorous endline evaluation; most targets met (WFP Rwanda/USDA, 2026)	M&E embedded in programme design; phased handover
Ghana	3.8M pupils; digitised monitoring	Not published in reviewed sources	Digitised monitoring system; 33% rise in agricultural sales via HGSF (CERFAM/WFP, 2026)	Legislation anchors programme; co-financing model established
International benchmark	WFP estimates \$9 return per \$1 invested (Duarte, 2024) under optimal conditions	WFP regional unit-cost benchmarks \$0.30–\$0.50/child/day	Returns contingent on M&E-verified delivery	Nigeria's unit cost falls below minimum threshold without inflation adjustment

Sources: WFP Rwanda/USDA (2026); CERFAM/WFP (2026); Duarte (2024); Okah (2022); World Bank/NASSCO (2025). Nigeria unit cost converted at approximate 2024 exchange rate for comparison.

The Rwanda endline (WFP Rwanda/USDA, 2026) is particularly instructive. A USD 25 million five-year investment across 140 schools achieved most evaluation targets, with M&E embedded, infrastructure aligned with training, and a phased government-handover mechanism. Nigeria's programme spent an estimated ₦131 billion in a single year (WFP School Meals Coalition) with no comparable evaluation architecture, no embedded third-party verification, and no public evidence of whether its claimed 10 million beneficiaries received meals of the quality and frequency the budget implied.

The November 2024 Global Alliance Against Hunger and Poverty 2030 School Meals Sprint commitment commits Nigeria to feeding 20 million children annually, launching school farms contributing 10 per cent of food items, engaging 250,000 smallholder farmers, and reducing out-of-school rates by 30 per cent by 2026 — with private sector funding covering 30 per cent of costs by December 2026. These are ambitious, measurable targets. Their achievability depends entirely on whether the governance and verification architecture described in Section 7 of this brief is in place before the programme scales to its new target.

7. Limitations of This Review

This brief is bounded by five honest limitations that the reader is asked to weigh against its findings.

- **Secondary-source-only design.** No primary fieldwork was undertaken. Every figure cited has a public-document origin, listed in the source matrix. Where official, civic, academic, and journalistic sources disagree, the disagreement is named in the body of the brief and is not silently resolved by the author.
- **Inability to verify federal reach claims against ground truth.** No independent registry of pupils fed, cooks engaged, or schools served exists for any programme year after 2020. The peak 2022 figure of 9,990,862 pupils is reported as a federal claim, not as an audited count. The brief treats it as such throughout.
- **Exchange-rate assumption for the WFP funding conversion.** The WFP School Meals Coalition figure of \$174.81 million (2023) is converted to ₦131 billion using the Central Bank of Nigeria 2023 annual average exchange rate of approximately ₦750 per US dollar. A different defensible rate (parallel-market, end-of-period, or CBN official-window 2023) would yield a different naira figure. Readers preferring a specific rate may recompute from the dollar source.
- **Inflation deflator construction.** The real-terms unit-cost line in Section 3.2 is built from NBS Food CPI annual averages, not monthly data, and uses 2016 as the base year. Pre-2025 inflation figures may be subject to NBS revision; the deflator should be re-rendered against the most recent CPI bulletin before any policy citation.
- **Absence of FOI response.** No Freedom of Information request was filed during the preparation of this brief. The recommendations section calls for the federal social-investment authority to publish what an FOI request might have surfaced. A future iteration of this brief may include FOI-extracted material if any such response is granted.

8. The Renewed Hope Relaunch: An Acknowledged Reset Without a Public M&E Floor

The post-2024 reset of the NHGSFP under the Renewed Hope Agenda represents the most consequential design change since 2016. Three operational pivots have been announced publicly. First, the federal government has signalled a target unit-cost range of ₦500 to ₦1,000 per child per meal — between five and fourteen times the legacy ₦70 rate (Adebowale/GazetteNG, 2025). Second, payments are to flow directly to mothers rather than to vendors, with the stated aim of cutting out an intermediary documented as a fraud surface in earlier programme years (Alausa, in Guardian Nigeria, 2025). Third, twenty-one states have been onboarded onto the National Education Data Initiative (NEDI) platform, intended to introduce digital monitoring of beneficiary identity and meal delivery.

Each pivot is, in isolation, a reasonable response to a documented earlier failure. Taken together, they amount to a soft admission that the 2016–2024 programme architecture could not be reformed in place. What the relaunch does not yet include is the M&E correction this brief argues for most insistently: a public quarterly dashboard, an independent verification line item in the federal budget, and a published cook and farmer registry with biometric anchoring. Without those, the Renewed Hope reset risks repeating the same accountability cycle on a more expensive substrate. The ₦500–₦1,000 unit-cost range, in particular, is at present a target without an indexation rule; a programme that learned its first lesson from inflation should not set its second target without one.

9. Recommendations

The following five recommendations are designed to close the measurement gaps identified in Sections 2 through 6. Each is scoped for implementation within NHGSFP's existing administrative infrastructure. No recommendation requires a new data collection system from scratch. Each builds on technology platforms, CSO partnerships, or legislative mechanisms already present in Nigeria's social protection ecosystem.

Recommendation 1: Public Quarterly Beneficiary and Disbursement Dashboard

Gap addressed: Section 5.2 — The Reporting Gap

Proposed indicator: Quarterly state-level count of pupils receiving meals and naira disbursed, published within 30 days of quarter-end

Rationale: No public verification of NHGSFP delivery has existed for any period since 2020. BudgIT Foundation (2026) and Dataphyte have demonstrated that real-time budget tracking is feasible in Nigeria's public finance environment. NSIPA's existing MIS and the NEDI platform (21 states onboarded per Agbajileke, 2025) provide the technical infrastructure. The governance decision to publish has not been made. This recommendation names that decision and provides a timeline for it.

Who acts: NSIPA, in coordination with the Federal Ministry of Education

What they do: Publish state-level pupil counts and disbursement figures within 30 days of each quarter-end, disaggregated by state, Local Government Area, and school

Why it is feasible: BudgIT Foundation has demonstrated the template; the NEDI platform provides the state-level data infrastructure

Time Horizon: Feasible within 90 days; no legislation required

Recommendation 2: Independent Verification Line Item in the Programme Budget

Gap addressed: Sections 4.1 and 4.2 — Delivery Bottlenecks and Fraud Timeline

Proposed indicator: Percentage of NHGSFP budget allocated to independent third-party verification by an accredited Nigerian research institution

Rationale: The NHGSFP has no published M&E budget allocation for any programme year. The entire verification function has relied on ad-hoc legislative probes (Baiyewu, 2020; Yakubu, 2024; Bakare, 2024; Akintola, 2025) and investigative journalism (ICPC, 2019; Adedigba, 2020) — both reactive, neither systematic. The CSO validation exercise of 2019 (ANEEJ/ActionAid/NESG) demonstrated that third-party monitoring is feasible and accepted by programme management. A minimum allocation of 1 per cent of programme budget — approximately ₦1 billion at the 2025 ₦100bn appropriation — would fund an annual independent verification cycle covering a statistically representative sample of schools and cook accounts.

Who acts: Federal Ministry of Finance, working with NSIPA

What they do: Ring-fence at least 1 per cent of NHGSFP annual budget for independent third-party verification, contracted through open tender to accredited Nigerian civil society or research institutions

Why it is feasible: Precedent exists: the ANEEJ CSO coalition has already performed verification in this programme; 1% of ₦100bn = ₦1bn — less than the cost of one fraud incident

Time Horizon: Next budget cycle (2027 appropriation)

Recommendation 3: Cook Registry Digitisation with Biometric Anchoring

Gap addressed: Section 4.1 — Phantom Beneficiary Lists; Cook Stipend Arrears

Proposed indicator: Percentage of active cooks in NHGSFP registry with verified biometric identity linked to a unique payment account

Rationale: The Kogi State fraud (ICPC, 2019) was possible because cook accounts existed on paper without biometric verification, allowing a Focal Person and Programme Manager to place accounts on lien without cook knowledge or consent. The programme's claimed workforce of 107,862–126,000 cooks has never been subject to a public verification exercise. A KoboToolbox-style verifiable registry with biometric anchoring — a technology already deployed in Nigeria's N-Power programme — would prevent account manipulation and enable accurate stipend-payment tracking.

Who acts: NSIPA, with technical support from the National Identity Management Commission (NIMC)

What they do: Digitise the full cook registry using a mobile data-collection platform; anchor each record to a National Identification Number (NIN); link to a designated payment account

Why it is feasible: N-Power biometric registration demonstrates precedent; NIMC NIN infrastructure covers more than 100 million Nigerians; the Kogi fraud (₦68M) alone would fund the registry build

Time Horizon: Pilot registry of 10,000 cooks in two states completed within 6 months Feasible within 180 days

Recommendation 4: Automatic Unit-Cost Review Trigger

Gap addressed: Section 3 — The ₦70 Question

Proposed indicator: Documented unit-cost review completed within 60 days whenever NBS food CPI rises more than 25 per cent from the preceding review baseline

Rationale: The ₦70 per-meal rate set in 2016 was not revised until 2022, despite food inflation exceeding 50 per cent over that period. The 2022 revision to ₦100 was approved but never implemented. By mid-2026, the real purchasing power of ₦70 has fallen to less than one-quarter of its 2016 value. A fixed nominal rate in a high-inflation economy is not a stable funding mechanism — it is a de facto annual meal-quality reduction. An automatic trigger, linked to published NBS food CPI data, removes the political friction from rate revision and creates a transparent basis for budget planning.

Who acts: Federal Ministry of Finance, on advice from NSIPA and the National Bureau of Statistics

What they do: Embed a unit-cost review clause in NHGSFP appropriation legislation, requiring a reviewed rate to be submitted to the National Assembly within 60 days whenever NBS food CPI exceeds 25 per cent growth from the preceding review baseline

Why it is feasible: NBS publishes monthly food CPI; the trigger mechanism requires only a legislative clause and an inter-agency communication protocol

Time Horizon: Clause included in 2026 Finance Act or NHGSFP enabling legislation; meaning it requires legislative instrument; 6–18 months

Recommendation 5: State Co-Financing Readiness Audit Before Any Federal Handover

Gap addressed: Section 4.1 — State Capacity Gaps; Section 2.2 — Reach Discrepancies

Proposed indicator: Published co-financing readiness score for each state, updated annually, covering four dimensions: budget commitment, payment infrastructure, school-survey coverage, and MIS integration

Rationale: NHGSFP's design assigns state governments responsibility for Primary 4–6 feeding, but no state co-financing readiness assessment has been publicly documented. The mismatch between federal claims of 33-state coverage and documented state-level failures — Kebbi's procurement scandal, unevenly deployed NEDI onboarding, cook stipend arrears across states — suggests that 'state participation' has never meant 'state co-financing confirmed'. Before any expansion toward the 50-million-pupil target (Adebowale, 2025) or the 2026 Global Alliance commitments (Global Alliance Against Hunger and Poverty, 2024), a state-by-state readiness audit is the precondition for deployment at scale.

Who acts: NSIPA in joint exercise with State Ministries of Education and the Office of the Auditor-General

What they do: Publish a co-financing readiness score for each participating state annually; make federal programme disbursements to states conditional on minimum readiness thresholds

Why it is feasible: Rwanda's phased transition model (WFP Rwanda/USDA, 2026) demonstrates feasibility; the co-financing conditionality approach is standard World Bank social protection design

Time Horizon: Readiness scores published for all current 12 pilot states, Feasible within 12 months

10. Notes on the Programme's Documented Achievements

This brief has been analytical and critical in posture, which is the appropriate register for an independent M&E review. Before the closing thesis, it is important to situate the measurement gaps identified here within a programme that has also generated documented positive effects at substantial scale.

11–42% Relative enrolment gains	A 2025 scoping review of eight qualifying studies (Malque Pub/Academic Research, 2025) finds a 11–42 percentage-point relative enrolment increase attributable to NHGSFP across evaluated sites. The width of that range reflects M&E inconsistency, not programme failure. Where rigorous measurement exists, enrolment gains are documented.
3.8× Growth in geographic coverage	From 14 states and 2.8 million pupils in August 2017 to claimed coverage of 33+ states and nearly 10 million pupils by 2022 — a programme that expanded its geographic footprint nearly fourfold in five years, a delivery achievement of real institutional significance.
127,000+ Community cooks engaged at peak	The cook-employment pathway — engaging predominantly women as local food preparers with formal stipend income — is one of the few NHGSFP mechanisms with documented positive secondary effects on women's economic participation (Okah, 2022; Majeed, 2021). Cook-employment is the programme's most defensible macro-economic multiplier.
40% vs 20% Food security among beneficiary farmers	The 2025 scoping review (Malque Pub/Academic Research, 2025) finds 40 per cent food security among smallholder farmers engaged in NHGSFP procurement versus 20 per cent among non-beneficiary farmers — a two-to-one advantage that, if sustained at scale, would represent a genuine agricultural poverty-reduction effect.
\$9:\$1 Estimated return-on-investment (best conditions)	UN OSAA (Duarte, 2024) synthesises international evidence estimating returns of up to \$9 for every \$1 invested in well-designed HGSF programmes. Nigeria's programme, at its structural design level, matches the multi-sector integration that generates those returns. Realising them requires the verification architecture this brief recommends.

The argument of this brief is not that NHGSFP's achievements are insufficient or should not be recognised. The argument is that they cannot be fully credited — or attributed to specific programme mechanisms — without a verification architecture capable of distinguishing genuine programme-induced effects from selection effects, reporting inflation, and input-activity confounds. A programme that achieves 11–42 per cent enrolment gains in eight qualifying studies but cannot tell us how many of its 10 million claimed beneficiaries actually received meals last month is a programme whose real achievements remain, in the M&E sense, unmeasured.

11. Closing Thesis

Nigeria's NHGSFP is Africa's largest school feeding programme by claimed scale. It has generated documented enrolment gains, smallholder procurement effects, and women's economic inclusion through cook employment. It has also produced a budget arithmetic that does not reconcile, a fraud timeline that compounds from ₦68 million in 2019 to ₦30 billion in 2025, and a reporting silence that has left 9 million children's daily meal status unverifiable for more than two years.

The programme measures what it does — funds released, cooks engaged, schools covered — with partial precision for administrative accountability. It does not measure the conditions that determine whether those inputs convert into outcomes: whether the cooks received their stipends on time, whether the meals met the nutrient standard the unit cost implies, whether the pupils whose enrolment was recorded actually attended and ate, and whether the financial flows that the budget documents authorised arrived at their intended destinations.

The five recommendations in Section 7 close those gaps. They are not ambitious redesigns. They are the minimum conditions under which a programme of NHGSFP's scale and ambition — ₦100 billion in 2025 appropriation, a 50-million-pupil target, international commitments to feed 20 million children by 2026 — can know, and demonstrate, whether it is feeding the children it claims to feed. The programme's bet on a daily meal was always theoretically sound. The M&E system capable of verifying whether the bet is paying off has yet to be built. This brief is the specification for that system.

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Annex: Source Matrix and Methodology

A.1 Methodology Note

This brief draws exclusively on secondary sources. All 34 sources were identified through systematic search of: (a) Nigeria's federal government portals and NSIPA communications; (b) the World Bank and UN publications catalogues; (c) BudgIT's Open Budget Portal; (d) legislative records from the House of Representatives Committee on Special Duties, Public Accounts, and Finance; (e) academic databases (Google Scholar, PubMed, CGIAR) for peer-reviewed NHGSFP evaluations; and (f) investigative journalism archives from Punch, Premium Times, Vanguard, Guardian Nigeria, Tribune Online, and BusinessDay.

Where quantitative figures conflict across sources — particularly beneficiary counts and budget disbursements — the conflict is documented explicitly rather than resolved by averaging. The decision rule applied throughout is: use the figure with the higher evidential weight (audited > legislative committee > federal administrative claim > media report), and flag all cases where no audited figure exists.

A.2 Limitations

- No primary data: This brief relies entirely on published open-source documents and media reports. It does not include Freedom of Information requests or interviews with programme officials.
- Budget data gap: Actual federal releases vs. allocations cannot be verified from open sources. BudgIT Foundation data partially fills this gap but does not cover all years.
- Sub-national data: Only one of 36 states (Kogi) has independently verified programme data (via ICPC fraud investigation). State-level performance cannot be assessed systematically.
- 2024–2025 data vacuum: No official implementation data exists for the post-suspension period. The assessment of current status relies on media reports and the World Bank Safety Nets review.
- Currency conversion: Where USD figures are cited, parallel market rates (~~≈~~ ₦1,500/\$ in 2024) may differ significantly from official rates, affecting international benchmark comparisons.

A.3 Full Source Matrix

Author / Institution	Date	Type	Key Content for this Brief
FMHADMSD	Jan 2023	Official Announcement	Programme overview, Jan 2023 status
Duarte / UN OSAA	Oct 2024	UN Policy Paper	HGSF as macro tool; \$9:\$1 ROI estimate
WFP Rwanda / USDA	Jan 2026	Evaluation Report	Rwanda endline; most targets met
Onah & Onah	Dec 2021	Academic Journal	Implementation issues; recommend ₦150/meal
Guardian Nigeria / Agbajileke	Sep 2025	Media Reporting	Relaunch announcement; 2.3M learners; 250k jobs stranded
WFP School Meals Coalition	2023	International Database	10M pupils 2023 — conflicts with suspension evidence
Baiyewu / Punch	Jun 2020	Legislative Oversight	₦186bn claimed; ₦64bn to feeding; inconsistent figures
Okah / Vanguard	May 2022	Media / Programme Profile	₦70 breakdown; 9.99M pupils; ₦100 approved not implemented
ICPC	Nov 2019	Fraud Investigation	₦68m Kogi fraud; cook accounts manipulated
Adedigba / Premium Times	Oct 2020	Investigative Journalism	₦2.67bn COVID-19 fraud; personal accounts
Yakubu / Punch	Jul 2024	Legislative Oversight	Reps call for suspension reversal
Majeed / BusinessDay	Aug 2021	Policy Commentary	Multi-sector design; cook employment; funding gaps
Guardian Nigeria	Aug 2017	Press Release Reporting	₦6.2bn; 14 states; 2.8M children; 33,895 cooks
Nairametrics	Jan 2025	Budget Analysis	₦100bn in 2025 budget
Bakare / Premium Times	Jul 2024	Legislative / Investigative	House probe; 9M pupils, 1.14M jobs projected
BudgIT Foundation	May 2026	Civic Accountability	Fiscal transparency; citizen engagement
Global Alliance Against Hunger & Poverty	Nov 2024	International Commitment	2030 Sprint; Nigeria 20M target; 250k farmers
State House / Presidency	May 2018	Official Press Release	30 states; 9.5M pupils; 101,913 cooks
NSIPA / GazetteNG (Adebowale)	Sep 2025	Policy Announcement	50M pupils target by 2026; ₦500–₦1,000/child
World Bank / NASSCO	Nov 2025	World Bank Report	0.14% GDP social protection; 44% benefits reach poor

ANEEJ/ActionAid/NESG	Jun 2019	CSO Validation Report	Third-party monitoring; SIPs confirmed effective
Malque Pub / Academic Research	2025	Systematic Review	8 studies; 11–42% enrolment gain; 40% vs 20% food security
Agu et al. / BMC Nutrition	Mar 2023	Academic Cross-Sectional	24 head teachers; no school kitchens; enrolment gains
CGIAR / IFPRI	2024	Impact Evaluation Baseline	Osun State RCT; endline pending 2025
NSIPA / RH-NHGSFP	2024	Official Programme Portal	Programme history; Renewed Hope restructuring
State House / Presidency	Dec 2017	Official Press Release	5.2M pupils; 19 states; deworming integration
CERFAM / WFP	Mar 2026	Good Practices Report	31 African countries; Ghana 33% agric sales increase
Akintola / Tribune Online	Dec 2025	Legislative / Investigative	₦30bn+ seized from NSIPA; Jan 2025 approval not executed
NSIO / ANEEJ	2016–2020	Baseline Study	National SIP baseline; NHGSFP implementation overview